

Publishing & Sharing Reports in Power BI

Comprehensive Assignment Solution

Q1. Explain why publishing and sharing reports is considered more important than just building dashboards in Power BI Desktop.

Building dashboards in Power BI Desktop is only the development phase of a Business Intelligence solution. The true value of a report is realized when it is published and shared with users who can use the insights to make decisions.

Publishing and sharing are important because:

- Reports become accessible through web browsers and mobile devices.
- Stakeholders can collaborate using a single version of the report.
- Data can be refreshed automatically.
- Business users do not need Power BI Desktop installed.
- Insights can drive strategic and operational decisions.

Therefore, publishing transforms a personal analysis into an organizational asset that delivers business value.

Q2. Define Power BI Service and explain its role in comparison to Power BI Desktop in the reporting lifecycle.

Power BI Service is Microsoft's cloud-based platform used to host, manage, and distribute Power BI content.

Power BI Desktop:

- Data import and transformation.
- Data modeling.
- DAX calculations.
- Report creation.

Power BI Service:

- Report hosting.
- Sharing and collaboration.
- Dashboard creation.
- Scheduled refresh.
- Security and governance.

Reporting Lifecycle:

1. Collect data.
2. Transform data.
3. Build reports in Desktop.
4. Publish to Service.
5. Share with users.
6. Monitor and maintain reports.

Both tools work together to create a complete reporting ecosystem.

Q3. What does publishing a report mean in Power BI? List any two outcomes that occur after a report is published.

Publishing means uploading a Power BI Desktop (.pbix) report to Power BI Service.

Outcomes after publishing:

1. Online Availability – Reports become available through the Power BI web portal.
2. Sharing and Collaboration – Reports can be shared with authorized users.

Additional outcomes:

- Dashboard creation.
- Scheduled refresh.
- Mobile accessibility.
- Security configuration using RLS.

Q4. List and explain the steps involved in publishing a report from Power BI Desktop to Power BI Service in the correct sequence.

Step 1: Build the report in Power BI Desktop.

Step 2: Save the PBIX file.

Step 3: Sign in with a Microsoft account.

Step 4: Click the Publish button.

Step 5: Select the destination workspace.

Step 6: Upload report and dataset.

Step 7: Verify successful publishing in Power BI Service.

Step 8: Configure refresh schedules, permissions, and security.

Following these steps ensures that reports are deployed correctly and made available to business users.

Q5. Differentiate between Report and Dashboard in Power BI based on structure and usage.

Report:

- Multiple pages.
- Detailed analysis.
- Created mainly in Power BI Desktop.
- Supports drill-through and extensive interactivity.

Dashboard:

- Single page.
- KPI-focused summary.
- Created in Power BI Service.
- Combines visuals from multiple reports.

Reports are used for deep analysis, while dashboards provide a quick overview of business performance.

Q6. Explain the difference between Direct Report Sharing, Workspace Access, and Power BI Apps. Also mention one use case for each.

Direct Report Sharing:

A report is shared directly with specific users.

Use Case: Sharing monthly sales performance with a regional manager.

Workspace Access:

Users are added to a collaborative workspace and assigned roles.

Use Case: A BI development team working together on reports.

Power BI Apps:

Reports are packaged and distributed to large audiences.

Use Case: Organization-wide reporting for all employees.

Apps are generally the most scalable and manageable method for enterprise reporting.

Q7. Describe the four workspace roles available in Power BI and explain how access control is managed using these roles.

Admin:

Full control over workspace settings, permissions, and content.

Member:

Can create, edit, publish, and manage content.

Contributor:

Can create and modify content but cannot manage workspace settings.

Viewer:

Can only view content.

Access control is managed through role assignments. Users receive only the permissions necessary to perform their responsibilities, supporting security and governance principles.

Q8. Why are Power BI Apps considered more secure and scalable than direct sharing? Explain this from a governance and enterprise usage perspective.

Power BI Apps provide centralized content distribution and governance.

Security Benefits:

- Controlled access.
- Reduced accidental sharing.
- Easier auditing and compliance.
- Distribution of approved content only.

Scalability Benefits:

- One app can serve thousands of users.
- Centralized updates.
- Reduced administrative effort.

From an enterprise perspective, Apps improve governance, maintain consistency, and reduce security risks compared to direct sharing.

Q9. Explain Row-Level Security (RLS) in Power BI. How does RLS ensure that different users see different data using the same report?

Row-Level Security (RLS) restricts data visibility based on user identity or role.

How it works:

1. Create roles in Power BI Desktop.
2. Apply filters to each role.
3. Publish the report.
4. Assign users to roles in Power BI Service.

Example:

A report contains sales data for North, South, East, and West regions.

A North Region Manager only sees North data, while a South Region Manager sees only South data.

Benefits:

- Enhanced security.
- Data privacy.
- Reduced report duplication.
- Easier maintenance.

Q10. Assume an organization shares reports without using Apps, workspace roles, or RLS. Discuss any three risks or issues that may arise related to security, governance, or data misuse, and explain how Power BI best practices help prevent them.

Risk 1: Unauthorized Data Access

Sensitive business information may become visible to unauthorized employees.

Prevention: Use RLS and role-based access.

Risk 2: Data Leakage

Reports may be forwarded or accessed by unintended users.

Prevention: Use Power BI Apps and controlled permissions.

Risk 3: Lack of Governance

Multiple versions of reports may circulate, creating confusion.

Prevention: Use centralized workspaces and managed app distribution.

Risk 4: Excessive Permissions

Users may accidentally modify or delete important content.

Prevention: Assign appropriate workspace roles.

Conclusion:

Power BI best practices such as Apps, Workspace Roles, and RLS improve security, governance, compliance, and trust in organizational reporting systems.

Conclusion

Publishing and sharing reports are critical stages in the Power BI reporting lifecycle. Features such as Power BI Service, Apps, Workspace Roles, and Row-Level Security help organizations deliver secure, scalable, and governed analytics solutions that support informed decision-making.